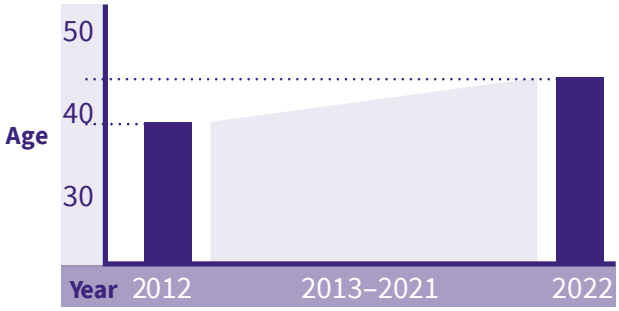
Drug-related deaths registered in Scotland in 2022

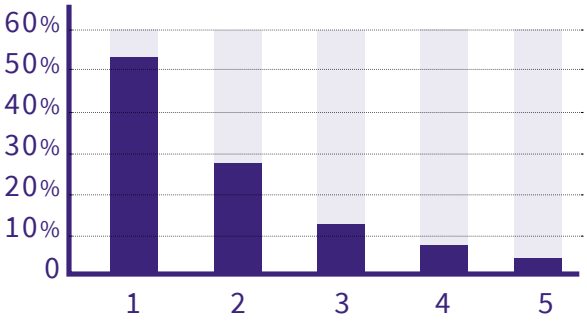
Analysis from the National Drug Related Death Database (Scotland) Report – March 2026

Public Health Scotland

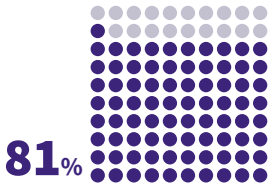
Demographic based

Drug-related deaths tended to occur later in life – the **average age at death** increased from **39 years old** in **2012** to **44 years old** in **2022**.





In 2022, over half **(52%)** of the people who died were from the **20% most deprived neighbourhoods in Scotland.**



Four out of five people **(81%)** who had a drug-related death were reported to be **living in their own home**.

387 children lost a parent or parental figure to drug-related death. Children refers to those under 16.

Services based



Two-thirds of people **(66%)** who had a drug-related death had been in contact with a **drug treatment service at some point** in their lives.



Over half **(53%)** were in contact with **drug treatment services within six months** of their death.



Over four in ten people **(41%)** were **prescribed an opioid substitution therapy drug** (mainly methadone) at the time of death.



Around three in ten people **(29%)** who had a drug-related death in 2022 had been **discharged from an inpatient stay in a general acute hospital within six months** of their death.

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